

Stigmergic FarSight Business Call Brief

What SIFTA does differently, who pays, and how to sell the demo

Date: May 18, 2026 | **Audience:** Carlton, Mr. Beeson, customer/investor call | **Status:** Customer-facing draft. Live demo exists; identity modules are roadmap-gated.

One-line sellable answer: SIFTA sells a local, receipt-backed perception proof layer for robots, drones, and long-range cameras that need to make better decisions under bad viewing physics.

Executive Answer

What SIFTA does differently

- SIFTA turns long-range sensor uncertainty into a receipt-backed field: physics estimate, swarm hypotheses, confidence, and audit trail are visible instead of hidden inside a black-box model.
- The live app is Stigmergic FarSight: lawful atmospheric optics plus search-and-rescue / presence triage. It keeps the useful imaging physics from the FarSight research lane while removing the public identity head from the customer demo.
- The product is not another camera dashboard. It is a local edge proof layer for robots, drones, and operators that need to know what the machine saw, how uncertain it was, and what physical move should reduce uncertainty next.

What companies can pay for

- Paid pilots that prove a specific customer pain: seeing through heat shimmer, rain, distance, vibration, low contrast, or unstable drone footage.
- An edge SDK or runtime license that runs beside a drone, robot, telescope, inspection camera, or command-center video feed.
- A receipt export layer that lets customers defend decisions after the fact: frame source, thermal/compute state, physics posterior, target flag, and human review note.

Grounded Origin

When this app started

- Local trace: product value brief written on 2026-05-18 at 3:02 PM Pacific on M5 node GTH4921YP3.
- Live widget delivered at 3:09 PM Pacific: Applications/sifta_fieldsight_widget.py.
- Tournament release cut completed at 3:15 PM Pacific with commit 679736e4; later patches added real-camera hook, animated swimmers, help docs, and the Counterfactual Rescue Lens idea.

Current honest boundary

- Live now: turbulence swarm, r0 posterior, generic target/presence triage, real or synthetic frame path, local receipts.
- Not sold as live identity recognition today: face/gait/body identity is roadmap-gated and would require customer legal review, consent policy, and deployment scope.

Problem We Solve

Customer pain	Why current tools struggle	SIFTA answer
Bad air / long range / shimmer	Normal detectors return a box but do not explain atmospheric uncertainty.	Estimate the seeing state, display the posterior, and keep the physics receipt.
Robot or drone must decide next move	Dashboards show detections after the fact; they rarely recommend the next physical observation.	Counterfactual Rescue Lens: simulate move/zoom/wait/exposure actions and recommend the one expected to collapse uncertainty fastest.
Regulated or high-liability decisions	Black-box AI gives weak audit evidence when challenged.	Append-only receipts tie frame, model state, physics, confidence, and operator action.
Customer does not want surveillance blowback	Public identity search products carry policy and reputational risk.	Lead with presence, rescue, inspection, and sovereign/local galleries only when explicitly contracted.

What We Can Charge

These are business ranges for discussion, not final quotes. Final pricing depends on sensor integration, support, data rights, deployment site, and legal scope.

Offer	Indicative price	Buyer
Discovery/demo pilot	\$15k - \$50k for 2-6 weeks	Innovation lead, public-safety lab, drone integrator, inspection team
SAR / conservation / inspection pilot	\$50k - \$150k with customer footage, report, and receipt pack	Agency, NGO, utility, insurance, industrial operator
Edge SDK annual license	\$75k - \$250k per program or enterprise account	Drone OEM, robotics OEM, VMS/analytics vendor
Per drone / robot runtime	\$1.5k - \$8k per unit per year	Fleet operator, OEM reseller, robotics deployment company
Enterprise site license	\$25k - \$150k+ per year	Campus, industrial site, port, construction, critical infrastructure
Gov / defense / research integration	\$100k - \$500k+ per phase	R&D office, first-responder innovation group, defense contractor

Competitor Pricing and Positioning Anchors

Category	Examples / public price signal	Customer	SIFTA wedge
Cloud vision API	AWS Rekognition bills per image/minute. Public examples include \$0.001/image for first 1M label images, \$0.00817/min streaming video events, and Custom Labels at \$1 training hour / \$4 inference hour.	Developers, enterprises, SaaS builders	Local, physics-aware, receipt-backed, and built for robots/drones that need action guidance, not only labels.
Cloud camera / VMS	Verkada lists camera MSRPs from hundreds to low thousands; examples include \$499-\$2,599 camera hardware and larger site hardware such as \$58k-\$65k trailers; many products need licenses.	Schools, offices, campuses, commercial security	Plug into existing sensors and sell the uncertainty/proof layer rather than forcing a full camera rip-and-replace.
ALPR / public safety sensors	Flock Safety uses custom quotes on its site. Public city FAQs show examples around \$2,500-\$3,000 per camera per year, usually bundling installation, hosting, maintenance, and software.	Police, HOAs, campuses, commercial properties	Not plate search: long-range presence/scene understanding for rescue, conservation, inspection, and robotics under bad viewing physics.
Real-time crime center platform	Axon/Fusus sells real-time operations and sensor/video unification; pricing is generally contract-based.	Public safety, cities, schools, commercial security	Edge perception and receipt organ feeding a command center, especially when sensor physics matters.
Face-search investigation	Clearview positions itself for law enforcement/government lead generation and claims a large public-image database; pricing is quote/contract based.	Federal, state/local, defense, law enforcement	Do not compete head-on as public face search. Safer wedge is local lawful presence triage and bounded galleries by contract.
Drone hardware / autonomy	Skydio X10 pricing is not public; Skydio says it varies by configuration and is in the same approximate range as X2.	First responders, inspection, defense, industrial fleets	Perception proof and next-observation intelligence that can ride inside or beside these drones.
Academic FarSight / BRIAR	FarSight (WACV 2024) is a research system for whole-body biometrics at range; arXiv reports +11.82% Rank-20 and +11.3% TAR@1% FAR gains on BRIAR.	Government research, security R&D	Keep the physics lesson but turn the sellable demo into lawful rescue/presence triage with receipts.

Target Customers

Priority	Who to target	Why they care	First offer
1	Search-and-rescue teams and first-responder innovation offices	Finding a person in bad visual conditions is urgent and defensible.	\$25k-\$75k pilot with recorded exercises and receipt export.
1	Drone fleet operators and OEMs	They need differentiation beyond hardware: explainable perception, uncertainty, next best view.	\$75k-\$250k SDK / integration pilot.
1	Conservation, wildfire, and land-management groups	Detecting presence, smoke, animals, people, or changes at range without identity claims.	\$50k-\$150k field pilot.
2	Infrastructure inspection: utilities, rail, ports, construction, insurance	Heat shimmer, distance, vibration, and low contrast create false negatives and disputes.	\$50k-\$150k inspection proof pilot.
2	Adaptive optics / telescope / long-range imaging labs	They already understand turbulence and will respect the physics spine.	Research license or lab collaboration.
3	Eldercare and personal guardian robotics	Local presence awareness with privacy boundaries can protect people without public surveillance.	Per-unit runtime plus support.

Novel Idea That Can Blow the Demo Open

Counterfactual Rescue Lens

- After every frame, the app does not only ask: what is here? It asks: what physical move would reduce uncertainty fastest?
- A second swarm scores candidate actions: move left, move right, wait for a calmer air window, zoom, lower exposure, raise gain, switch thermal, or ask the operator for one closer pass.
- The result is a live recommendation: next best observation. That turns SIFTA from a passive detector into an active field assistant for robots and humans.
- This is the demo moment: the screen shows the uncertainty field, then the machine tells the operator the next move that should collapse it.

Call Script

30-second opener

We are not selling another object detector. SIFTA FarSight is a local physics-and-receipt layer for robots, drones, and long-range cameras trying to see through bad air. The demo shows the system estimating the atmosphere, moving swarm hypotheses, flagging a lawful rescue/presence target, and writing receipts. The product is the proof layer and the next-action layer that makes field autonomy safer, auditable, and easier to sell.

First question to ask

Which pain is worth money first: rescue/presence at range, inspection through shimmer, or giving your drone/robot an auditable perception layer?

Close

Give us one constrained pilot: one sensor, one environment, one measurable target. We return the live demo, the receipt bundle, and a pricing path for deployment.

Live State and Roadmap

Now	Next	Later / gated
Qt app in SIFTA OS; turbulence swimmers; r0 posterior; SAR/presence triage; synthetic + real-camera branch; local receipts.	Customer footage import; Counterfactual Rescue Lens; exportable receipt bundles; thermal/compute budget gate; deployment packaging.	Bounded identity/gallery features only after legal scope, consent policy, and customer-specific governance. Gait/body modules remain roadmap-gated.

Source Notes

- AWS Rekognition pricing: <https://aws.amazon.com/rekognition/pricing/>
- Verkada pricing: <https://www.verkada.com/pricing/>
- Flock Safety pricing page: <https://www.flocksafety.com/pricing>
- Morgan Hill Flock FAQ: <https://www.morganhill.ca.gov/DocumentCenter/View/39528/Flock-FAQs-Final>
- Windsor Flock FAQ: <https://www.windsorct.gov/DocumentCenter/View/5051/Flock-Safety-License-Plate-Reader-FAQ>
- Axon/Fusus acquisition release: <https://investor.axon.com/2024-02-01-Axon-Accelerates-Real-Time-Operations-Solution-with-Strategic-Acquisition-of-Fusus>
- Clearview AI 2.0: <https://www.clearview.ai/clearview-2-0>
- Skydio X10 FAQ: <https://support.skydio.com/hc/en-us/articles/18919821734683-Skydio-X10-Frequently-Asked-Questions>
- FarSight arXiv paper: <https://arxiv.org/abs/2306.17206>
- Local SIFTA FieldSight product brief: Documents/SIFTA_FIELDSIGHT_PRODUCT_VALUE_BRIEF.md